



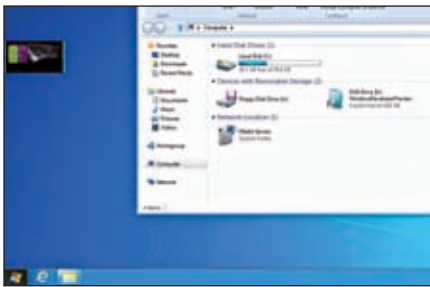
Personalised memory!

Silicon Power has announced its range of limited edition storage devices
<http://bit.ly/q6YGgx>

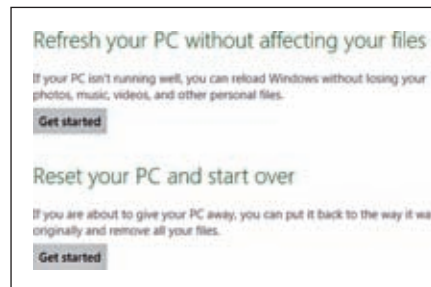


The more the merrier

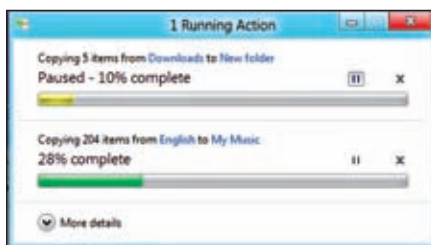
Google has purchased over 1,000 patents from IBM to further enhance its patent portfolio
<http://bit.ly/pEEBq4>



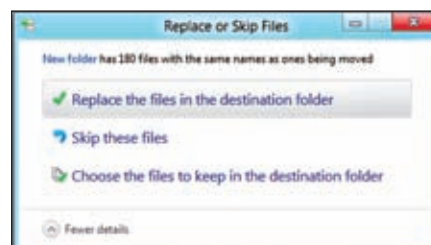
As you hover your mouse on the edge, a preview of other running apps appears. You can click it to switch to the app or drag it to dock it



The refresh and reset options in the Metro control panel. They're also available in the regular control panel



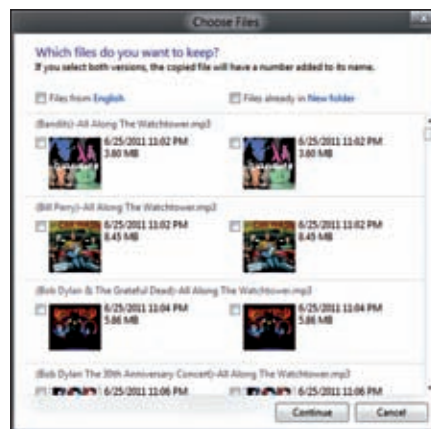
Standard view of copy progress. One copy operation is paused



Conflicts while copying are now better presented



Expanded view of copy progress



A fine-grained control over managing conflicts, yet easy to exercise

your installed applications as a collection of tiles. What's great about these tiles is that they're not only a way to launch applications, but also act as small windows into the application. A tile for your email app could show you your unread email count, your social networking app could show the latest posts, your image management app could show a slide show of images etc.

We say "could" because right now apps don't support this functionality – remember this is the preview that's sup-

posed to get developers to start developing apps for Windows 8 and the sample apps that are included, showcase it quite well. The news app shows news from configured feeds, the Twitter app shows tweets and the stocks app shows stocks. Apps launch in full screen but can be made to share space as well. Applications, whether Metro, traditional or web, can be pinned on to the Metro start screen.

If you start typing on this Metro start screen, you'll immediately see a filtered list of installed applications and what's

more, you can search in settings and files as well. Here comes the awesome part, you can search from this screen within applications as well! Applications expose their data to Windows which can then search within that data as well. An example would be if Amazon's Kindle e-Book reading app supported this feature – you'd be able to search for e-books directly from Windows.

Windows 8 comes with Internet Explorer 10 and a Metro interface that does not allow plug-ins such as Flash and Silverlight. This UI is highly optimised for tablet devices, but is functional on desktops and laptops as well.

The login / lock screen has received some Metro love and now finally displays the current time. It can even be extended to show data from some applications – another useful feature for tablets.

A completely new Metro-styled control panel is also available, which offers a simpler way to configure most common settings for you PC.

Even the boot process has been revamped to use a Metro-style UI. You can select which OS to boot using your mouse / touchscreen. This makes sense for tablets, where, there would be no keyboard to make an OS selection.

Hovering near the edge of the screen shows a preview of other running applications; this preview can be dragged onto the screen to make it share space with the current app or take over the screen.

All of this is available in addition to the more traditional Windows UI, which we talk about later in the article. However, you needn't use the traditional UI if Metro is all you want. What's great is that these two can co-exist and even co-operate by sharing screen space between metro and traditional apps.

Windows 8 "classic" UI

One of the biggest losses in this whole Metro thing is the Start Menu (RIP 1995 - 2012). The Windows 8 Developer Preview does not feature the traditional start menu; instead it launches the Metro start screen described above. We emphasise "Developer Preview" because this could very well change by the time the final version releases.